

Determining Award Type

Review the characteristics below when determining the award type. Do not rely solely on the terminology the sponsor is using in the award document.

Comparative Characteristics

	Purpose	Typical Key Features
Grant	Provide financial support for public purposes with minimal restrictions	Conceived by Principal Investigator (PI) Highly flexible scope of work and budget Minimal sponsor involvement Periodic payments or cost reimbursable Flexible re-budgeting Less strict responsibility for producing specific results Part of the prime grant awarded to UI from a pass-thru entity would be a Subaward
Cooperative Agreement (CA)	Support a public purpose with substantial involvement between parties	Conceived by PI Typically, flexible scope of work and budget Substantial involvement expected from the sponsor Periodic payments or cost reimbursable Usually flexible re-budgeting Requires collaborative approach to project implementation Part of CA funds awarded to UI from a pass-thru entity would be a Subaward
Contract	Procure specific goods or services for direct benefit	Conceived by sponsor Relatively inflexible scope of work and budget High level of responsibility to deliver results Payment based on deliverables and milestones More restrictive re-budgeting Frequent reporting requirements Part of the prime contract awarded to UI from a pass-thru entity would be a Subcontract
Letter Award	Similar to grant	Conceived by either PI or sponsor Flexible scope of work and budget No formal agreement Letter will usually state minimal information Flexible re-budgeting Typically, no terms & conditions for the award Part of the prime grant awarded to UI from a pass-thru entity would be a Subaward
Gift Funding	Funds given to UI Foundation that are for the UI	Conceived by either PI or donor Little or no reporting requirements Flexible scope of work and budget No formal agreement Flexible re-budgeting These are rare

Purchase Order Similar to a Contract

Conceived by sponsor
Relatively inflexible scope of work and budget
High level of responsibility to deliver results
Payment based on deliverables and milestones
More restrictive re-budgeting
Frequent reporting requirements
PO may sometimes be part of a Grant award, if so, treat as a grant.

How to Identify the Award Type:

1. Sponsor Involvement

- No to minimal involvement Likely a Grant, Letter or Gift
- Substantial collaborative involvement Cooperative Agreement
- Expects very specific deliverables Likely a Contract or a Purchase Order

2. Project Origination

- Conceived by PI with research freedom Grant, Cooperative Agreement, Letter or Gift Funding
- Defined by sponsor with specific expectations Contract or Purchase Order

3. Payment Structure

- Lump sum payments or Cost Reimbursable Grant, Cooperative Agreement, Letter or Gift Funding
- Milestone-based payments Contract or Purchase Order

4. Project Purpose

- Research and development projects Grant, Cooperative Agreement, Letter, or Gift Funding
- Procurement of goods or services Contract or Purchase Order

1. Reporting Requirements

- Annual reporting Grant or Cooperative Agreement
- Frequent, detailed reporting Contract or Purchase Order
- Minimal or None – Letter or Gift Funding